Build Your AI Digital Brain: Prompt Guide

A Digital Brain is a folder of plain notes on your own computer that an AI agent reads, files and keeps tidy for you. You drop in raw material. The agent turns it into linked pages. Each week it knows a bit more about your work, so you stop explaining yourself from scratch every time you open a chat.

You need three things:

1. **Obsidian**, a free note app that reads plain markdown files. Download it at https://obsidian.md
2. **An AI agent that can read and write files on your computer.** Any agent will do, as long as you can point it at a folder.
3. **The LLM Wiki pattern**, the method the agent follows. Read it once before you start: https://gist.github.com/karpathy/442a6bf555914893e9891c11519de94f

The prompts below work in any AI agent. Copy them as they are, then change the parts in square brackets.

1 Create the folder in Obsidian

1. Open Obsidian.
2. Choose **Create new vault**.
3. Name it `Digital Brain` and save it somewhere easy to find, such as your Documents folder.
4. Leave it empty. The agent builds the inside.

Keep the name short and plain. A long name with symbols or a folder inside a folder of the same name causes trouble later, when scripts and agents have to type the path.

2 Point your AI agent at the folder

Open your AI agent and give it the `Digital Brain` folder as its working folder. How you do this depends on the agent. Most have an "open folder" option, or you start it from inside the folder.

Check that it can see the folder before going further:

PROMPT TO COPY

```
List the files in this folder and tell me its full path.
```

An empty folder is the right answer.

3 Ask the agent to build the draft

This prompt asks the agent to read the LLM Wiki pattern and set up the skeleton. Paste it whole.

PROMPT TO COPY

```
Read the LLM Wiki pattern at
https://gist.github.com/karpathy/442a6bf555914893e9891c11519de94f

Then set up this folder as my Digital Brain using that pattern. I use
Obsidian to read it.

About me: [your job, your business, what you want to remember, e.g.
"I run a small training company in Kuala Lumpur and write a weekly
LinkedIn post"].

Build:
1. A raw folder for source material I drop in. You never edit those files.
2. A wiki folder for pages you write: one page per person, company,
   idea or source.
3. An index page listing every wiki page with a one-line summary.
4. A log page where you note what you did each session, newest at the
   bottom.
5. A rules file in the top folder that explains all of this, so any AI
   agent I open here later follows the same rules.

Use plain markdown and Obsidian [[wikilinks]]. Show me the folder tree
and the rules file before you write anything else.
```

Read the rules file it shows you. This is your one chance to shape the system cheaply. If a rule does not fit how you work, say so now:

PROMPT TO COPY

```
Change the rules: [what you want different]. Then show me the updated
rules file.
```

4 Sketch the ground floor

Now give the agent something real to file, so you see the pattern work end to end. Start with yourself.

PROMPT TO COPY

```
Interview me. Ask one question at a time, up to 10 questions, about my
work, my customers, my current projects and what I keep forgetting.
After the last answer, write the first pages of my Digital Brain from
what I said: one page about me, one per project, and one per person or
company I mentioned. Link them to each other and add them to the index.
```

Open Obsidian afterwards and click through the pages. The graph view (left sidebar) shows how they link.

5 Capture notes on the go

Ideas turn up on the train, in a meeting, at 2am. Pick one capture tool you already carry on your phone and stick to it. Common options:

- **Notion**: a capture page or database you type into from the phone app.
- **Google Docs**: one running document called "Inbox", newest note at the top.
- **Telegram**: a private bot or a "Saved Messages" chat you send notes, links and voice memos to.

Each one needs a small bridge so the notes land in your `Digital Brain` raw folder. You do not have to know how to build it. Ask the agent:

> **PROMPT TO COPY**
>
> ```
> I capture notes on my phone using [Notion / Google Docs / Telegram].
> Help me set up a way to pull those notes into the raw folder of my
> Digital Brain, one file per note, with the date in the filename.
> Explain each step in plain words, tell me what you need from me (an
> account, a token, a setting), and wait for me before you do anything
> that sends data outside my computer.
> ```

Tips:

- **One inbox only.** Three capture apps means three places to forget.
- **Capture fast, sort later.** Do not tidy on the phone. A one-line note with a link is enough.
- **Empty the inbox weekly.** Ask the agent to go through new captures with you: keep, file into a page, or bin.
- **Never put passwords, bank details or private client data in a capture app.** Whatever you send there passes through someone else's servers.

6 Save web pages with Web Clipper

Copying a web page by hand loses the headings, links and author. **Obsidian Web Clipper** is a free browser extension that saves the page as a clean markdown file, the format AI reads most easily. Get it at https://obsidian.md/clipper

Set it to save into your raw folder. Then:

PROMPT TO COPY

```
I clipped a new page into the raw folder: [file name]. File it: write
a short summary page, link it to any existing pages it relates to,
update those pages with what is new, and add it to the index and log.
Tell me if it contradicts anything already in the Digital Brain.
```

7 Feed it what you have already made

Your old posts and videos already hold years of your thinking. Feed them in.

LinkedIn posts. On LinkedIn, go to Settings, then Data privacy, then **Get a copy of your data**. Ask for the full archive. LinkedIn emails a download link, usually within a day.

YouTube videos. Use Google Takeout (https://takeout.google.com) for your channel's video list, or ask the agent to pull the titles, descriptions and transcripts of your public videos.

Put the export files in the raw folder, then:

PROMPT TO COPY

```
I put my [LinkedIn export / YouTube export] in the raw folder:
[file or folder name]. Convert anything that is not markdown into
markdown first. Then write one page per [post / video] with the date,
the link and three key points, and pull out the recurring ideas into
their own pages. Show me the list of recurring ideas before you write
them.
```

If the agent cannot open a file type, ask it to set up the tool it needs. That is part of its job.

Everyday prompts

Ask a question:

PROMPT TO COPY

```
What does my Digital Brain say about [topic]? Answer from the wiki
pages only, and name the pages you used. If the answer is not there,
say so.
```

Save a good answer:

PROMPT TO COPY

```
That answer is worth keeping. File it as a new wiki page, link it to
the pages it used, and add it to the index.
```

Health check, once a month:

> **PROMPT TO COPY**
>
> ```
> Check the Digital Brain: broken links, pages no other page links to,
> pages that say the same thing, and claims that two pages disagree on.
> List what you find. Do not fix anything until I say which ones.
> ```

Tips

- **Start small.** Ten good pages beat 500 empty ones. Feed it one source a day for two weeks before you bulk-import anything.
- **Raw stays raw.** Never let the agent edit what you dropped into the raw folder. That is your proof of what the source said.
- **Ask it to show before it writes** when the change is big, such as new rules, renaming folders or a bulk import.
- **Keep a backup.** The folder is just files. Copy it to a drive, or ask the agent to set up version history with git.
- **Watch what you put in.** If the folder syncs to a cloud drive, so does everything inside it. Keep truly confidential material out.
- **Stuck on setup? Ask the agent.** "Help me set this up, step by step, and explain what each step does" works for nearly every tool in this guide.